

Meditations On Selflessness

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Dedication

For in Him I live, and move, and have my being (Acts 17:28).
This Book is dedicated to God who is selfless.

Acknowledgement

This book is not just written, it was taught and lived. I had the privilege of mentoring an exceptional team of young men and women at different times on certain onsite and online platforms. It is relevant parts of the content taught over the years at these platforms that were worked into the books, of which this is one. I want to appreciate these uncommon proteges and everyone at the Wisdom Place, House of Insights, and other mentoring platforms, most of whom were the first set of people I shared the insights that were harvested into the pages of this book.

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Preface

In this present world where 'self' seems to be king; people seek what is best for them even if it is at the detriment of others. However, God's love remains selfless at heart, putting the interests and commands of God as utmost priority and putting the interest of others ahead of one if need be.

The whole essence of God's commandments is Love. A selfless life is an expression of an authentic Christian faith and a vital measure of Christian maturity. Living selflessly is a vital way to live out your faith as a believer.

These meditations, when applied effectively, will work a selfless heart into you. Do well to find a suitable environment and engage these meditations effectively. Prayerfully confess these scriptures routinely and continually.

It takes time for the things of the spirit to crystalise, so these meditations will become tangible in your life after a lengthy time of use.

Meditations On Selflessness

People say, 'An eye for eye, and a tooth for a tooth.', but I don't not repay the evil person with evil. If someone strikes me on the right cheek, I turn to him the left also. If someone wants to sue me and take my tunic, I quickly let him have my cloak as well. If someone forces me to go one mile, I go two miles. I give to the one who asks me and do not turn away from the one who wants to borrow from me.
(Matt. 5:38-43 KJV paraphrased).

People say, 'Love your neighbour and hate your enemy. But I love my enemies and pray for those who persecute me, that I may be a true son of my Father in Heaven who causes His sun to rise on the evil and the good and sends rain on the righteous and the unrighteous. If I love only those who love me, what reward will I get? Are not even the people of the world doing that? If I greet only nice and courteous people, what am I doing more than unbelievers? Do not even worldly people do that? I become mature therefore, as my heavenly Father is perfect. (Matt. 5:44-48 KJV paraphrased).

I am His disciple, I deny myself [I disregard, lose sight of, and forget myself and my own interests]. I take up my cross and follow Him [I cleave steadfastly to Him, conform wholly to His example in living and, if need be, in dying, also]. (Matt. 16:24 AMP).

I humble myself as a little child, so that I can be great in the kingdom of heaven. (Matt. 18:4 KJV).

I do not exalt myself less I become abased; I humble myself, so I can be exalted. (Matt. 23:12 KJV).

I do not seek the honour of men. I seek the honour of God,so I do only as My Father bids me. If men do not receive, recognize or approve me, I am not overly concerned about human validation. How can I believe God or please Him, if I seek the honour (recognition, praise, approval, validation) of men and not the honor that comes only from God? (John 5:41-45 KJV paraphrased).

I do not speak for myself, I do not seek glory for myself, I seek to honour and glorify God, who sent me. So I speak truth, not lies. I do things for the glory of God and not for my own praise. (John 7:18 NKJV paraphrased).

Truly, except a corn of wheat falls into the ground and die, it abides alone, but if it dies, it brings forth much fruit. As a corn of wheat, I lay myself down to die so that through my death, much fruit can be brought forth for God. I do not seek to preserve my life (reputation, success, ministry, wellbeing, ego, advancement), or else I shall lose them. I disregard my life (my own interests, ambition, quests and success) in this world, so I can keep them unto life eternal. (John 12:24-25 KJV paraphrased, some additions mine).

I serve Jesus, I follow Him so that where He is, I also as His servant can be, I do not seek the honour (recognition, approval, praise) of men. I serve so that God the Father can honour (recognise, lift and reward) me. (John 12: 26 KJV paraphrased, some additions mine).

I do not think of myself more highly than I ought to think; but I think soberly, according as God hath dealt to me a measure of faith. (Rom. 12:3 KJV).

I love sincerely and selflessly. I hate what is evil; I cling to what is good.I am devoted to others in brotherly love. I honour others above myself and I prefer others above myself. (Rom. 12:9-10 NIV).

I do not live for 'myself' and I do not die for 'myself'. For as I live, I live unto the Lord; and when I die, I die unto the Lord: whether I live therefore, or die, I am the Lord's. (Rom. 14:7 – 8 KJV).

I do everything with the consciousness that I shall give account of myself to God. (Rom. 14:12 KJV paraphrased).

I am spiritually strong, so I tolerate the infirmities (wrongdoing, selfishness) of the weak. I do not live to please myself. But I selflessly please others (my neighbours) for their good to edification. For even Christ (the most selfless), pleased not Himself; but, as it is written, the reproaches of them that reproached thee fell on me. (Rom. 15:1-3 AMP, some additions mine).

I am aware that it matters very little how I am evaluated by men or by any human authority. I can't even trust my judgment of myself on the issue of my faithfulness, well-doing, motives and rightness/wrongness. It is the Lord Himself who examines me, judges and decides. Therefore, I live with the consciousness that my heart has to be right and bare before the Lord who judges my hearts, motives, thoughts, intentions, acts and ways. (1 Cor. 4: 3-4 NLT, some additions mine).

I don't make judgments about anyone; It is only when the Lord returns that He will bring all our darkest secrets to light and reveal all our private motives. Then God will give to each one whatever praise or rebuke that is due.
(1 Cor. 4:5 NLT).

I do not begin to commend myself. I do not, as some others, arrange letters of commendation from men. I let my life, humility, results and fruits in the lives of men be my letter of commendation, written in their hearts, known and read of all men. (2 Cor. 3:1-2 NKJV, paraphrased).

I am crucified with Christ; nevertheless, I live; yet not I, but Christ lives in me: and the life which I now live in the flesh I live by the faith of the Son of God, who loved me, and gave himself for me. I do not frustrate the grace of God,for if righteousness came by the law, then Christ is dead in vain. (Gal. 2:20-21 KJV).

When other believers fall into sin, I gently and humbly help them up to the right path. I am not judgmental, and I am careful not to fall into the same temptation myself. I share other people's burdens thereby obeying the law of Christ. I don’t ever deem myself too important or big to serve people. I see myself as nothing , God is the only one that counts. (Gal. 6:1-3 NLT, some additions mine).

I imitate God as His dear child. I walk in love and selflessness, as Christ also has selflessly loved me and has given Himself for me, as an offering and a sacrifice to God for a sweet-smelling aroma. (Eph. 5:1-2 NKJV).

I agree wholeheartedly with others, I love others. I work together with others in one mind and purpose. I am not selfish, I don't try to impress people. I am humble, I think of others as better than myself. I don't look out only for my interests, but I take an interest in others too.
(Phil. 2:2-4 NLT).

I make myself of no reputation, I take the form of a servant, and I present myself in the likeness of a common man. I humble myself and become obedient to God to the point of death, I lay down my life for God and sacrifice myself for others if need be. (Phil. 2:7-8 KJV).

I speak as a person approved by God and entrusted with the gospel. I do not try to please men, but God, who tests my heart. I never use flattery, nor do I put on a mask to cover up greed, envy, bitterness and offences (God is my witness). I do not look for praise from men, nor from you or anyone else. I seek only the praise, commendation and recognition that comes from God (1 Thess. 2:4-6 NLT).

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About the Book

Whatever one meditates and speaks into one's life sufficiently, certainly becomes one's experience and reality. There are few spiritual routines that are as powerful as taking what God has said concerning your life and brooding over them in your heart and declaring them over your life consistently.

This book harvests scriptures on selflessness, so that you can appropriate them into your life. The end result of this book is that you will be filled with selflessness as a harvest of your continuous and repeated prophesying of these scriptures on selflessness into your life.



About the Author

Davids Oluwaseye Ayodele is a trainer, speaker and writer. He is graced with understanding and presenting complex issues with simplicity and clarity for practical application.

He is the founder of several initiatives both within the Church and the workplace, such as The Wisdom Institute of Leadership and Ministry for training and equipping ministry leaders, ENABLED Multiconcept for business and professional leadership development and consultancy, as well as several other platforms for Bible-based teaching ministry. He has a bachelor's degree in Chemical Engineering and a master's degree in engineering management from Ahmadu Bello University, Nigeria. He is married to Deborah OluwaNifemi and they are blessed with children.